

Germany Academic & Europass CV Guide

A clean academic CV (Lebenslauf) is critical for gaining admission to tuition-free public universities and securing DAAD scholarships. This guide highlights the essential structures required by German academic committees.

Format & Layout Standards

- **Length:** Keep the CV strictly to 1 or 2 pages. German evaluators prefer concise, dense summaries over lengthy pages.
- **Chronological Order:** Use reverse-chronological order. Your most recent education or work experience must be at the top.
- **Design:** Use clean sans-serif fonts (Helvetica, Arial, Inter) with a clear hierarchy. Avoid flashy colors; stick to dark blue, black, or grey accents.

Crucial CV Sections

- **Academic Background:** List university name, degree title, major, GPA (converted to the German scale, 1.0 being best, using the Modified Bavarian Formula), and thesis title.
- **Research & Technical Projects:** Detail your academic and independent projects. Highlight role-fit by specifying the technologies used and provide links to public repositories (e.g. GitHub).
- **Professional Experience:** List industrial internships or student assistantships, focusing on technical and problem-solving contributions rather than administrative duties.
- **Skills:** Categorize into Languages (English and German CEFR levels like A1-C1), Programming, Tools, and Lab Competencies.

The Rule of Practical Proof

German professors value practical proof over motivation. Do not write generic descriptions like 'worked on automation project.' Write specifically: 'Implemented a 3-axis robot control loop in C++ using ROS2, reducing positioning error by 14%.' Provide links to code repositories as proof of work.